

whatweretheythinking.com

www.berting.nl/seventies/

A glance at www.berting.nl/seventies/ and “why?” and “for whom?” immediately pops up: it's just images—and not hi-res at that! Granted, the seventies must have been an interesting era, but information on the period and its trends could have been helpful. Unfortunately, this is not to be. All the site has are pictures, more pictures, and even more pictures from the seventies. An entire page's length of pictures categorised under such sections as Cars, Fashion,

Film and TV, Furniture, Houses, Posters and so on.

The thumbnails can be enlarged: “Click an image to enlarge,” we're encouraged. However, a click opens the images in a new page in just slightly larger dimensions! Nothing remotely useful about the stuff in the images is mentioned, either; it's just pictures, you see! Some of the things in the pictures are good keepsakes from the seventies,

and it would have been cool to be able to order the stuff. But this is not to be, either—remember the mantra: just pictures!

Many of the pics are repeated—fourteen (whew!) pictures of the “ball chair,” and we've lost count of the number of featured images from the TV show *Barbarella*.

A link at the bottom of the page leads to something called “Futuro house”—a house that had been designed (in the seventies, of course) for the future, but which never became popular. The page has promising links to different versions of the house, but our elation was deflated when we found that, well, the links don't work. And don't even get us started on good site design practices.

Whatever it was designed for, this page is, unfortunately, *not* a window to the soul of the seventies. If you've heard your folks talk fondly of that time, make sure they never get here!



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even grounds for divorce, game sex online will be considered much more so!

THE UPPER CREST

\$400 A Month For E-Mail

For a little less than \$400 a month, you can proclaim your financial status in the digital world. Millionaires24.com, owned by Munich, Germany-based Netlite GmbH, is calling on those who consider themselves as making up the upper crest of society to sign up for one of their exclusive e-mail accounts—thereby rising above the cheapo crowd, who go with free e-mail.

The company's Web site asks, “Do you own a luxury car and enjoy the exclusivity? Of course... But why restrict yourself? With an e-mail address at Millionaires24.com, you will show all your e-mail

recipients that you have made it!” And then there's this gem: “An ordinary person cannot afford \$399 per month for an e-mail address.” Now that's all neat and spelt out for you!

Proprietor Christian Mader believes the time has come for a service like his, which the Web site compares to a “virtual diamond ring.”

“There are so many people out there who want to show their status and their wealth on the Internet also,” he is reported to have said. “m24 is the best shortcut to communicate financial status.”

So what do you get with an m24 account? Nothing much, except for unlimited e-mail and sundries like a date reminder. It's all about the status symbol value, of course.

To guarantee exclusivity, only 10,000 memberships are available. We're sure that number will go up—why should Mader limit himself to \$4 million a month for such a wonderful idea? ■

Blog WATCH

Google's calendar service is out, and blogs are abuzz with this bit of news. Newspapers are catering to newsbots. ESP is now also the acronym for a mind-reading device. And a reader muses over what the end of blogging might mean

Ryan Oakley

<http://snipurl.com/paxg>
(<http://thegrumpyowl.blogspot.com/2006/04/mind-reading-machine.html>)

Mind reading machine

The good people at MIT's Media Lab have invented—seriously—a mind reading prosthetic device. It's called the Emotional Social Intelligence Prosthetic. But don't worry there's an acronym. ESP...

So far the major application is for high functioning autistic people but MIT has repeatedly been asked if it can detect flirting. I can save everyone at MIT a bit of time here. There's no need to program that into the machine. If you're wearing a mind reading device on your head no one is flirting with you.

Angel

<http://snipurl.com/paxn>
(<http://gypsylibrarian.blogspot.com/2006/04/what-if-bloggers-vanished.html>)

What if bloggers vanished?

From Boing Boing, a tale of what would happen if bloggers actually disappeared. The story is “Plumage from Pegasus” written by Paul DiFilippo. I found myself speculating what if the various obstacles of spam, excessive regulation, viruses, and terrorism did bring down the Internet. At any rate, an interesting read. I wonder what would I do if the Internet disappeared, and I could not blog anymore.

(*Plumage From Pegasus* is located at www.sfsite.com/fsf/2006/pdf0602.htm)

Clive Thompson

<http://snipurl.com/paxm>
(http://www.collisiondetection.net/mt/archives/2006/04/how_google_news.html)

Google News influences Newspaper headings

To try and entice the search-engine bots of Google, Yahoo, and MSN, newspapers are beginning to alter their prose style. One of the biggest areas of change is headline-writing. Normally, a headline writer tries to use some witty wordplay to attract readers, but such nuances are totally lost on machines. A bot is trying to quickly figure out the content of an article, and wordplay just gets in the way...

Granted, most of the newsbots out there are a little more intelligent than that. But not always.

Dave McClure

<http://snipurl.com/pb14>
(http://500hats.typepad.com/500blogs/geeks_tech_star_tups/index.html)

Google Calendar (aka ‘CL2’) is alive

Looks pretty sweet...Nice integration with Google Maps too... I didn't even put in a street address, but it still figured out the general area.

Hmmm. Think I'll spend some more time investigating this one. Could be worth the switch.